

ECHOES

Talk with San Luis Obispo's history.

ECHOES is an interactive way for your visitors to have a real conversation with a figure from local history. The first is **Myron Angel (1827–1911)**, pioneer journalist, county historian, and the father of Cal Poly. Ask him anything, and he answers in his own 1905 voice.

What makes ECHOES different from ordinary AI: **every word Myron says is drawn only from real, validated historical sources** — primary documents, his own 1883 *History of San Luis Obispo County*, and other public-domain records. Never the open internet. Never invented. It is history that is **accountable to the evidence**.

HOW IT WORKS

- **Ask a question** in plain language, or tap a suggested one.
- **Myron answers in character**, grounded in real sources about our county.
- **Every answer is labeled by evidence:** Documented · Reasonable inference · Contested · Not in the sources.
- **"Show evidence"** reveals the exact citations; **"Hear this"** reads the reply aloud in an aged, period voice.
- **He shows historic photographs:** the Mission, Morro Rock, old downtown, Port Harford, the early Polytechnic, the Chumash, the rancho era, and more.
- **When the sources don't support an answer, he says so.** It shows its work, so it teaches source-checking instead of replacing it.

TRY IT NOW (LIVE BETA)

<https://echoes-inky-zeta.vercel.app/>



Open on any phone or computer — no app, no account.

Note: The first question may take 30–60 seconds while Myron's source library loads — like opening a heavy archive volume. After that, replies are much faster.

Suggested questions: Who were you? · Tell me about the mission. · What did San Luis Obispo look like in your time?

WHY I'M REACHING OUT

I'm **Matthew Kennedy**, a **Cal Poly MSBA alumnus and six-year resident of San Luis Obispo**. I'm building ECHOES to **promote history learning** in our community and to **advance responsible research into accurate, source-grounded AI**. Your knowledge and feedback are exactly what will make Myron accurate and worthy of trust.

YOUR ROLE AS A BETA PARTNER

Try ECHOES and tell me what's accurate, what's missing, and what would make it valuable to you. In return:

- **Free use during the beta** (no licensing fee).
- **Small at-cost AI usage only** — typically a few dollars a month, with an optional monthly cap.
- **A direct hand in shaping the product** before it goes fully live.

No software to install. No IT work. Just a web link or QR code beside an exhibit.

WHERE THIS IS GOING

Today, Myron is a text-and-voice conversation. Next, with your help, ECHOES becomes a **living portrait** — a moving picture frame of Myron you speak with face to face. Beta partners help decide which San Luis Obispo stories we tell next.

LET'S TALK

I'd be glad to show you a **15-minute live demo**, in person or by phone, whenever suits you.

Matthew Kennedy · ECHOES

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ECHOES is an AI simulation grounded in public-domain historical sources. Answers are labeled by evidence and may contain errors, which is exactly why your expertise matters.